

Blue Ranger 3

Billy's last film as a Ranger on Earth. It plays the role *Captain America: Civil War* played for Marvel: friends divided over a principle, and a villain who profits from the split.

Field	Detail
Release date	Friday, June 11, 2021
Distributor	Walt Disney Studios Motion Pictures (20th Century Studios label)
Rating / runtime	PG-13 / 165 minutes
Real title	Blue Ranger 3
Decoy title	Split Decision
Whose film it is	Billy Cranston , the original Blue Ranger, now the Zeo team's technical genius

WHY THIS DATE

June 11, 2021

- By June 2021, New York and Los Angeles theaters had reopened and vaccines were widely available. That's the window our 2020 Release Strategy picked for theatrical recovery. The film is clear of *F9* (June 25) and *Black Widow* (July 9).

01 • TITLE: REAL AND DECOY

Blue Ranger 3, shot as Split Decision

- **Real title:** *Blue Ranger 3*.
- **Decoy title:** *Split Decision*. It sounds like a sports drama and hides the team's split.

02 • WHOSE FILM IT IS

Billy Cranston

- Billy against Jason: the Captain America and Iron Man of the MGU, on opposite sides.
- **Faithfulness lock:** Billy's aging and departure for Aquitar, Jason's dangerous Gold power, and Rita and Zedd's destruction of the Machine Empire all happen as in canon.

03 • WHEN AND WHERE IT'S SET

MGU Year Four: summer–fall 2016

- Angel Grove, the Power Chamber, the Moon, the Machine Empire's fleet, and Aquitar at the end.

04 • WHAT IT'S ABOUT

Two friends, one principle

- Billy has two problems. The first is his own: a side effect of the age restoration from *Alien Rangers* has started **aging him rapidly**. The second is Jason: Billy's scans prove the **Gold power is killing him**.
- Billy demands that Jason give the power up. Jason refuses, because the war with the Machine Empire isn't won and the team needs its Gold Ranger. The Rangers take sides, and friends who have fought together since 2013 end up facing each other.
- **The Zemo role:** Rita and Lord Zedd, back from M51, have been waiting for exactly this. While the Rangers are divided, they deliver their canon "gift" to King Mondo, a bomb that **destroys the Machine Empire's royal family**, and take back their place at the top of evil.
- **Climax:** the split team reunites against the Machine Empire's final assault, too late to stop Rita and Zedd from winning the bigger game.
- **Ending:** Billy's aging can only be cured on Aquitar. He says goodbye to the team and leaves Earth for good, with Cestria, as in canon. The Jason question is left unresolved.

05 • VILLAIN / ANTAGONIST

King Mondo, and Rita and Zedd behind him

- **King Mondo** and the Machine Empire at full canon power, and **Rita and Lord Zedd** as the schemers who wipe out the royal family and take the throne of evil back.

06 • POST-CREDITS SCENES

Two scenes

- **Mid-credits: "The Call."** In the Power Chamber, a signal Alpha has never seen before arrives from Eltar. Zordon goes silent. This sets up *Zordon*.
- **End-credits: "Aquitar."** Billy, already looking younger, stands in a sea of blue water and laughs for the first time in the film.

07 • SETTING UP THE BIG BAD

A vacuum on the board

- With the Machine Empire gone, there's an empty space in Dark Specter's hierarchy. In a brief cutaway, a pirate emblem moves toward Earth's sector. That's **Divatox**.

08 • ITS OWN WORLD-BUILDING

Billy's world

- Billy's aging condition, the Gold power's toll, the end of the Machine Empire's royal family, and Aquitar as Billy's new home.

The rules every later film builds on

- **Rangers can disagree, and lose each other.** The last of the original five leaves Earth.
- **Rita and Zedd are back on top,** setting up their place in the Alliance.

10 • ITS ROLE IN PHASE 3

How it opens the phase

- It ends the Zeo era, takes Billy off Earth, and leaves Jason's fate and Eltar's call open for the films that follow.

This is a fictional, alternate-history development document created for creative purposes. Characters and events follow the original Power Rangers television series (Mighty Morphin through In Space, plus the 1997 Turbo film). Where canon is silent, the film fills the gap without contradicting it.